





THE NEW TRIANGLE
L-R, CM Mohan Yadav; deputy CMs Rajendra Shukla and Jagdish Devda

dyed-in-the-wool BJP worker—which matters in a state like MP where a decent number of party MLAs and leaders have come from the Congress ranks. He cut his teeth in student politics, and was president at the Madhav Science College in Ujjain, his alma mater. In 1997, he became a member of the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha state executive, marking his entry into party politics.

In the 2003 assembly polls, he was nominated for the Badnagar seat outside Ujjain town but opted out after being dubbed an outsider. He then became chairman of the Ujjain Development Authority and later of the MP State Tourism Development Corporation.

THE NEW CM REALISES THE IMPORTANCE OF TAKING ALONG THE STALWARTS IN THE STATE BJP, PERHAPS WHY HE HAS BEEN VISITING MANY OF THEM PERSONALLY

Meanwhile, Yadav, while pursuing his political goals, had not lost sight of his academic targets. He has a weighty academic resume with B.Sc., LLB, MBA, MA in Political Science and even a Ph.D. He also organises the 'Voice of Ujjain' talent contest every year, which also serves as an outreach effort.

EYE ON THE BIG PRIZE

So, what sealed the deal in favour of Yadav? BJP sources say that besides effecting a generational change, the party also felt that having a Yadav CM would help its cause in Bihar and Uttar Pradesh in the general election.

Yadav got his big break in 2013 when he secured a BJP ticket, and won, from Ujjain South. The winning streak continued in 2018 and 2023. In 2020, when the BJP returned to power after a coup that saw the fall of the Kamal Nath government, Yadav was appointed minister for higher education. He was at the helm when the National Education Policy was announced. "He set up task forces and closely monitored the implementation. He also introduced around 150 new courses and got a law college in Ujjain," recalls an IAS officer who worked for him. Yadav's quick decision-making is what most administrators in Ujjain remember. "Whenever a decision to free roads of encroachment to improve infrastructure came up, Yadav was always pro-development," says an official earlier posted as DM, Ujjain.

After being elevated unexpectedly to high office, Yadav, perhaps aware of the